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Digital Literacy Project Report

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Introduction

As a newly appointed Student Digital Ambassador, this project serves as a foundational step in mastering and promoting digital literacy within the VIT Bhopal community. The primary objective is to build a comprehensive Digital Literacy Portfolio that demonstrates proficiency in professional communication, online safety, and collaborative digital tools. Over the course of five distinct modules, this project covers essential skills ranging from creating visual infographics and establishing a professional online presence to understanding the complexities of cybercrime and professional email etiquette. By organizing these tasks within a central GitHub repository, I am not only documenting my learning process but also creating a permanent, professional resource. This project highlights the transition from being a passive consumer of digital content to becoming a responsible, savvy, and professional digital citizen.

Task 1 Write-up: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For Task 1, I utilized **Canva** to create a one-page infographic focused on the fundamentals of digital literacy and safe internet practices. My design specifically illustrates the definition of digital literacy, highlights essential tools for college students like Google Workspace and GitHub, and provides a quick-reference guide for maintaining strong password hygiene. The visual layout was structured to be easily digestible for my batchmates, using icons and concise bullet points to ensure key information stands out. One thing I found particularly interesting during this process was the variety of educational templates available, which made the design process much more intuitive than I expected. However,

the most challenging part was narrowing down the information to fit into a single, cohesive visual without cluttering the page. This exercise taught me the importance of visual hierarchy—how colour and placement can guide a reader's eye toward the most critical safety tips first.

Task 2 Write-up: Student Digital Portfolio

In this task, I established my foundational digital presence by setting up and updating profiles on **LinkedIn, GitHub, and Kaggle**. LinkedIn serves as my primary professional networking hub where I have documented my current education at VIT Bhopal and set my expected graduation year. On GitHub, I created a personalized profile README to introduce myself, stating my branch and my goal of mastering software development and version control. Kaggle was chosen to explore the data science community and track my future progress in machine learning competitions. Over the next four years, I plan to use these platforms dynamically. LinkedIn will be used to connect with industry professionals and secure internships, while GitHub will act as a live portfolio for my coding projects and academic assignments. Having these platforms ready from my first year ensures that my professional footprint grows alongside my academic achievements, making me more visible to potential recruiters.

Task 3 Write-up: Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

Task 3 involved engaging with coding practice and cloud collaboration tools. For Part A, I used **Hacker Rank** to complete the 'Solve Me First' challenge, which allowed me to practice basic input/output logic in a competitive coding environment. For Part B, I designed a five-question 'Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz' using **Google Forms**. This quiz

includes a mix of multiple-choice and short-answer questions designed to test knowledge of phishing and professional etiquette. These tools will be immensely helpful in my academic journey. Hacker Rank provides a platform to sharpen my problem-solving skills, which is crucial for technical interviews. Google Forms and the associated Google Sheets response view provide an efficient way to collect data and collaborate on group projects or research surveys. Mastering these collaboration tools ensures that I can effectively manage team-based tasks throughout my degree.

Task 4 Write-up: Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

I explored a scenario where a student sent an informal email using slang to a professor, which led to a delay in help because the tone was perceived as disrespectful. This highlighted that digital communication is about clarity and respect for the recipient's time. Drafting the sample emails—one for a deadline extension and another for an internship—taught me how to balance a professional greeting with a concise body. Developing the social media checklist reinforced that a digital footprint is often a first impression. Maintaining 'Do's and Don'ts' is essential to prevent impulsive posting that could affect future careers. This task showed me that professional etiquette is a vital skill for ensuring my messages are handled seriously in academic and professional settings.

Task 5 Write-up: Cybercrime Awareness & Prevention

Researching cybercrime was eye-opening, especially the prevalence of UPI fraud in India. What surprised me most was how sophisticated phishing attacks have become, often mimicking official university messages to create a false sense of urgency. I realized how easily a single click on a suspicious

link could compromise my data. As a result, I will personally change my habit of clicking on links in unsolicited messages without verifying the sender through official channels. I have also committed to enabling two-factor authentication on all my accounts. Creating the 'Stay Safe Online' checklist helped me internalize actionable steps, like using the National Cyber Crime Portal (1930) for reporting. This task has made me more vigilant about my digital interactions, ensuring I can protect my security and better advise my peers as a Digital Ambassador.

Conclusion

Completing this Digital Literacy project has been a transformative experience that broadened my understanding of the digital ecosystem. Beyond just learning how to use specific platforms like GitHub or Canva, I have gained a deeper appreciation for the responsibilities that come with being a Digital Ambassador. I now feel confident in my ability to present a professional online identity, communicate effectively through formal channels, and maintain a high level of security against cyber threats. These skills are foundational to my success as a B.Tech student and future professional. This project has effectively bridged the gap between basic internet usage and professional digital citizenship.

References

- **Canva:** canva.com
- **GitHub:** github.com
- **LinkedIn:** linkedin.com
- **HackerRank:** hackerrank.com
- **Google Forms:** forms.google.com
- **National Cyber Crime Portal:** cybercrime.gov.in